Problem Discovery, Market & User Research

Uber: Find My Ride

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Uber: Find My Ride

1. Market Research and Competitor Analysis

1.1 Analyze demand across user segments

Why This Research Matters?

As a Product Manager, the first job is not to jump to solutions. It is to understand whether the problem is real, who is affected most, how large the opportunity is, and what constraints exist. This document answers those questions for Uber's pickup coordination challenge before any solution is considered.

The pickup confusion problem does not affect all users equally. Some people face it every single day while others rarely experience it. Understanding who is most affected, and why, helps us decide where to focus first.

The core question this section answers: Which users face pickup coordination problems most often, and how painful is it for them?

What We Mean by 'Pickup Coordination Problem'

After booking a ride, users often do not know exactly where to stand. In simple locations like a quiet residential street, this is easy. But in complex environments — a busy IT park with ten towers, an airport with two terminals, or a mall with five exits — the pin on the map is not enough. Riders wonder which gate to use, drivers navigate to the wrong entrance, and both end up calling each other in frustration. Sometimes the driver cancels. Sometimes the rider gives up.

User Segments: Who Is Most Affected?

Below are the key user groups, ordered roughly from most to least affected by pickup confusion.

User Segment	How Often They Ride	Location Complexity	Pain Level	Primary Pain Point
Office Commuters	Daily	Very High	★★★★★	Multiple towers & gates, security checkpoints
Airport Travelers	Frequent	Very High	★★★★★	Designated zones, terminal confusion, paid parking
Metro / Railway Users	Daily	High	★★★★☆	Multiple exits, heavy footfall, fast-moving traffic
Mall Visitors	Weekly	High	★★★★☆	Multiple exits, large footprints, parking zones

Corporate / B2B Users	Daily	High	★★★★☆	Fixed gate requirements, SLA sensitivity
College Students	Regular	Medium	★★★☆☆	Campus entry/exit confusion
Hospital Visitors	Occasional	Medium	★★★☆☆	Multiple wings, emergency vs. main entry
Residential Users	Regular	Low	★★☆☆☆	GPS inaccuracy at building level

A Closer Look at the Top Segments

A. Office Commuters — The Highest-Frequency Sufferers

Think of someone working at Hitech City in Hyderabad, Manyata Tech Park in Bangalore, or Cyber Hub in Gurgaon. These campuses can have ten or more towers, each with its own entrance. A driver navigating to 'Tower 7, Gate B' from an Uber pin placed at the campus center can easily end up at the wrong side of the building — half a kilometre away. The rider waits. The driver calls. Both lose time. This happens every single workday.

India's six biggest Uber cities — Delhi-NCR, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Mumbai, Pune, and Kolkata — are all dominated by exactly these kinds of large, complex office campuses. Office commuters are Uber's most frequent and most loyal users, which makes this the highest-priority segment.

B. Airport Travelers — High Stakes, Zero Tolerance for Error

Airport pickups are uniquely stressful. A person who just landed after a long flight, carrying luggage, with a connecting commitment, has no patience for a confused pickup. Indian airports like Hyderabad, Bangalore, Delhi, and Mumbai all have designated pickup bays that are often far from terminal exits, poorly signed, and congested.

The global data makes the stakes clear: at San Francisco International Airport, when the rideshare pickup location changed, Uber's cancellation rate jumped from 8% to 28% in a single weekend. Wait times nearly tripled. That kind of disruption is not just a bad experience — it is a revenue and retention crisis. Airport travel is also one of the top two use cases for Uber Black, Uber's premium offering, meaning these are high-value riders who expect a premium experience.

C. Metro & Railway Station Users

Metro stations in Indian cities like Delhi, Bangalore, Hyderabad, and Mumbai typically have four or more exits. The rider may exit at Exit 3 while the driver is waiting near Exit 1. With heavy foot traffic, narrow roads, and no-stopping zones immediately outside many stations, even a small navigation mismatch creates a long walk or a cancellation. These users often ride daily,

meaning repeated friction quickly turns into habit changes — switching apps or walking to an auto instead.

D. Women Riders — Safety Is Non-Negotiable

95% of women riders say safety is the main reason they choose Uber. For this segment, a pickup going wrong is not just inconvenient — it is alarming. Standing at the wrong spot, being approached by an unverified vehicle, or waiting alone in a poorly lit area because of a pin mismatch all raise the stakes significantly. Smarter pickup guidance that gets the rider into the right car quickly is a direct safety improvement for this segment.

E. Corporate / B2B Users

Companies that use Uber for Business need predictability. If an employee misses a pickup because the driver arrived at the wrong gate, it reflects on the company's travel management. This segment is the fastest-growing in India's shared mobility market, with businesses increasingly tying up with ride-hailing platforms for employee transport. Any solution that improves pickup reliability directly strengthens Uber's enterprise proposition.

Key Hypothesis: *The strongest demand for a smarter pickup experience comes from office commuters, airport travelers, and metro/railway users. These three groups should be the primary targets for user research and any pilot.*

1.2 Identify and size the target market

Target Market Identification & Sizing

Before investing in building a solution, we need to understand how big this opportunity actually is. Market sizing gives us a rational basis for the investment decision.

We use the standard TAM → SAM → SOM framework, which simply means starting with the total universe and narrowing down to what is realistically addressable.

TAM — Total Addressable Market

This is the entire ride-hailing market in India, which includes all trips taken on all platforms — Uber, Ola, Rapido, Namma Yatri, and others.

India's e-hailing market was valued at approximately USD 2.78 billion in 2025 and is projected to reach USD 4.92 billion by 2030, growing at 12% per year. A more aggressive estimate from another research house puts the market at USD 3.77 billion by 2032, growing at nearly 19% annually.

In trip volume terms, Uber alone covered 11.6 billion kilometers in India in 2025 — a 26.5% increase over the previous year. At an average trip distance of roughly 8 kilometres, this translates to approximately 1.4–1.5 billion Uber trips in India annually.

SAM — Serviceable Available Market

Not every trip has a pickup coordination problem. Simple residential pickups from a quiet street are usually fine. The problem is most acute in complex pickup environments: airports, tech parks, malls, metro stations, and railway stations.

If we conservatively estimate that 30–40% of all Uber rides originate from these complex environments, the serviceable market is approximately 420–600 million trips per year in India.

SOM — Serviceable Obtainable Market

Within complex-environment trips, how many actually experience pickup confusion or failure? A LocalCircles survey of 3,500 frequent users in Bengaluru found 85% of Uber users reported one or more issues in the past year, with cancellations being the top complaint. Conservatively attributing 20–25% of these issues specifically to pickup coordination problems gives us:

Sizing Formula

~1.4 billion trips/year × 35% from complex locations × 20% experiencing pickup issues

= approximately 98 million problematic pickups per year

= approximately 8 million problematic pickups per month

Even if assumptions vary, the number is significant. A 10–15% improvement in pickup success on these trips would mean millions of better experiences monthly — and meaningful recovered revenue through reduced cancellations and improved retention.

Global Context

The pickup coordination problem is not unique to India. It exists in Jakarta, São Paulo, Nairobi, Lagos, and New York — wherever dense urban environments create complex pickup conditions. The global ride-hailing market is projected to grow from USD 219 billion in 2026 to USD 497 billion by 2035.

A solution built and tested in India — the world's largest and most complex ride-hailing environment — has strong potential to become a global Uber standard. India is the right lab for this.

1.3 Study existing alternatives users rely on today

Before designing any new feature, a PM must understand how users are currently solving the problem themselves. Workarounds reveal the real gap between what the product provides and what users actually need.

The fact that users have developed so many creative workarounds is itself the strongest signal that this is a real, persistent problem — not an edge case.

What Riders Do When the App Fails Them?

1. Call the Driver

This is by far the most common workaround. The rider calls the driver and gives verbal directions: 'I'm near the Starbucks,' or 'I'm at Gate 3, the one next to the ATM.' This works sometimes, but it depends on both parties speaking the same language, the driver being reachable, and neither being in a no-signal zone. It adds 2–5 minutes to every pickup and is entirely invisible to Uber's systems.

2. Share Location via WhatsApp

Technically-savvy users get the driver's number from the app and drop a live WhatsApp location pin. This bypasses the Uber app entirely — which means Uber has no visibility into the coordination happening outside its platform, cannot improve the experience, and risks losing that trust layer to a third-party app.

3. Give Landmarks Instead of Address

Riders describe their location using visible landmarks: 'Near the SBI ATM,"Beside Metro Pillar 104,"Opposite the food court entrance.' This works reasonably well in familiar areas but fails when the driver is from a different part of the city and does not know local landmarks. It also puts the burden entirely on the rider.

4. Walk to a Findable Spot like Main Gate

Many riders in India do not wait at their pin location at all. They anticipate the confusion and pre-emptively walk to a more findable spot — the main road, a prominent gate, or a petrol bunk. This completely defeats the purpose of setting an exact pickup location in the app, adds walking time, and is an invisible signal of failure that never gets captured in Uber's data.

5. Use Pre-Booked Cab Services for High-Stakes Trips

For airport trips and important travel, many experienced users abandon on-demand apps entirely and book a cab in advance through Meru, a hotel service, or a known driver's personal number. Pre-booked services solve the pickup coordination problem by fixing the meeting point in advance through a phone call. These users are effectively telling us they do not trust the app when the stakes are high.

What Drivers Do When They Cannot Find the Rider?

- ***Call the rider and ask for verbal directions or landmarks***

- ***Stop at the nearest accessible road and wait for the rider to walk over***
- ***Cancel the trip after waiting — especially during peak hours when another booking is available***
- ***Ask riders to move to a different spot ('Can you come to the main gate?')***

What Competitors Are Currently Doing

No platform has fully solved this problem. Here is where each major player stands today:

Platform	Current Pickup Guidance	Gap / Limitation
Uber	Basic pin + ETA. Tested 'Suggested Pickup Points' in SF in 2015.	Feature never scaled to India. No active guidance once ride is booked.
Ola	Basic pin + ETA only.	Same gap as Uber. 93% of Ola users in Bengaluru reported issues.
Rapido	Basic pin + ETA only.	No differentiated pickup coordination feature.
Namma Yatri	Uses Google Maps Routes API with live traffic for precise location.	Better accuracy but no active pickup guidance. Zero commission reduces cancellation incentives.
Grab (SEA)	Suggested pickup in complex locations like Changi Airport. Building integration pilots.	Early-stage. Only in Singapore / KL context. Not deployed in India.
Google Maps	'Pick me up here' pin placement, walk-to-point suggestions.	Not integrated with ride-hailing booking flow.
Pre-booked Cabs (Meru etc.)	Human-coordinated, fixed meeting points arranged over phone.	Solves the problem but sacrifices on-demand convenience.

The Key Gap: No platform in India owns the 'last 100 metres' of the pickup journey — the moment between ride confirmation and the rider actually getting into the car. This is where confusion, cancellations, and frustration live. Whoever solves this owns a meaningful differentiation.

Uber has actually already built the intellectual foundation for this: the company holds a patent for a system that automatically suggests pickup locations based on historical trip data, scoring spots for optimized pickup time. The capability exists on paper — it just has not been deployed at scale in India

1.4 Assess restrictions, rules and other laws

Any product feature that changes how pickups work — especially one that involves precise location tracking, suggests riders move to different spots, or modifies where fare meters begin — must be designed within India's regulatory framework. This section is often skipped in PM exercises, but ignoring it can sink a feature post-launch.

Central Government — Motor Vehicle Aggregator Guidelines 2025

India's Ministry of Road Transport and Highways released updated aggregator guidelines in July 2025. These are the primary rules governing how Uber and other platforms operate nationally.

- ***Fare Must Start at the Pickup Point***

The guidelines clearly state that fare must be charged only from the pick-up to the drop-off point. This means that any feature suggesting a rider move to an alternate pickup location must carefully handle where the fare clock starts. If the app guides a rider 200 metres to a better pickup spot, the fare must still begin at the rider's new confirmed pickup — not at their original pin. This is both a product design requirement and a legal compliance requirement.

- ***No Dead Mileage Charges Within 3 Kilometres***

The updated rules clarify that platforms cannot charge drivers for dead mileage (the distance to reach a rider) if the pickup is within 3 km of the driver's current position. This means that if a suggested alternate pickup point is still within that radius, it does not create an additional financial burden on the driver — making it commercially safer to offer pickup point adjustments.

- ***Vehicle Location Tracking is Mandatory***

All vehicles operating on aggregator platforms must be equipped with Vehicle Location and Tracking Devices integrated with the platform's backend. This is actually an enabler: it means real-time driver location data is legally mandated and available. Any smart pickup coordination feature can build on this foundation without needing to justify the tracking infrastructure.

State-Level Rules: Maharashtra & Haryana

Maharashtra

Maharashtra's draft aggregator rules, released in late 2025, require apps to provide real-time location sharing for passengers. This is a significant enabler: it opens the door for in-app bidirectional location sharing between rider and driver — one of the core building blocks of a

smarter pickup coordination system. Maharashtra covers Mumbai, Pune, and Nashik — three of Uber's top markets.

Haryana

Haryana has banned new petrol and diesel vehicle onboarding from January 2026, pushing fleets toward CNG and EVs. This matters for pickup design because EV-specific constraints (charging station locations, range considerations) may eventually influence where drivers can and cannot go — creating new dimensions for pickup point optimization.

Airport-Specific Rules

Indian airports — operated by AAI and private operators like DIAL (Delhi), BIAL (Bangalore), MIAL (Mumbai), and GHIAL (Hyderabad) — each have their own pickup zone policies. Drivers are not permitted to stop anywhere; they must use designated ride-hailing bays. These zones are often far from terminal exits and poorly communicated to arriving passengers.

Any feature that guides riders to better airport pickup points must be developed in coordination with airport authorities. This is as much a business development and operations problem as it is a product one. No app can unilaterally redesignate pickup zones without airport approval.

Data Privacy — DPDP Act 2023

India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act (2023) governs how user location data is collected, stored, and shared. Key requirements for any smart pickup feature:

- Consent must be explicit — riders must agree to share precise real-time location
- Purpose limitation — location data collected for pickup coordination cannot be used for other purposes without separate consent
- Data minimisation — only the location data needed for the pickup may be collected
- Historical 'popular pickup spots' data built from aggregate past trips must be anonymised and compliant with data retention rules

The DPDP Act is still in its early enforcement phase, but building with compliance from day one is both the right approach and a competitive differentiator as enforcement tightens.

Consumer Protection

In January 2025, the Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) issued notices to both Ola and Uber regarding differential pricing for Apple and Android users. This signals that the CCPA is watching ride-hailing practices closely. Any feature that could be perceived as manipulating pickup points to influence fare amounts must be clearly communicated, auditable, and fair — or it risks drawing similar regulatory attention.

1.5 Assess market trends

Market trends help answer the question: Is now the right time to solve this problem? The answer here is a clear yes — several converging forces are making smarter pickup coordination both more feasible and more necessary.

Trend 1: India's Hyperlocal Mapping Infrastructure Is Growing Up

India-specific mapping platforms like MapmyIndia (Mappls) are building building-entrance-level mapping accuracy — something global platforms like Google Maps do not always have in India's dense urban environments. This means the underlying data to know 'Gate 3 of Manyata Tech Park is the correct driver entrance' is becoming available.

Geospatial data is now seen as core national digital infrastructure in India. As 300 million more people move to cities over the next 25 years, investment in this layer will only increase. Uber can build on this emerging infrastructure to create pickup intelligence that is specific to Indian environments.

Trend 2: Uber India Is at a Scale Where Small Improvements Have Enormous Impact

Uber trips in India grew 26.5% year-on-year in 2025 to over 11.6 billion kilometers. At this scale, even a 1% improvement in pickup success rates translates into millions of better experiences every month. The ROI case for investing in pickup coordination strengthens with every new rider and every new city Uber adds.

Trend 3: Regulatory Direction Supports Real-Time Features

State governments are mandating real-time location sharing and stricter grievance redressal. This is the regulatory wind blowing in the same direction as the product. Features that would previously require justification — like in-app live location sharing between rider and driver — are now being encouraged by law. Uber is in an unusually good position where the product roadmap and the compliance roadmap are aligned.

Trend 4: Competition Is Intensifying on Experience

Namma Yatri has grown to 10 million users and 100 million trips with a zero-commission model that structurally reduces driver cancellations. If the pickup experience on Uber continues to frustrate — especially in Bengaluru and Hyderabad, where Namma Yatri is strongest — switching is easy. A survey of 3,500 frequent ride-hailing users in Bengaluru found none of the platforms were fully satisfying users, with many explicitly saying they would switch to whoever fixed the experience. Superior pickup coordination becomes a retention tool in an increasingly crowded market.

Trend 5: Users Now Expect Apps to Be Proactive, Not Just Reactive

The generation of users riding Uber today has grown up with AI-powered recommendations, predictive text, and context-aware apps. They expect apps to anticipate their needs, not just

respond to them. A static pin on a map feels increasingly outdated when everything else in their digital life is smart and contextual. The shift in user expectation is a pull factor — users want this feature even if they cannot articulate it precisely.

Trend 6: AI and Machine Learning Make This Feasible

Uber already holds a patent for an ML-based system that scores historical pickup locations to suggest better options. The company has the data — billions of past trips, thousands of complex locations, driver GPS traces — to train models that know where pickups succeed and where they fail. What was technically complex in 2015 when the feature was first tested in San Francisco is now far more achievable with modern ML tooling and Uber's accumulated India-specific data.

Summary: Key Findings at a Glance

The five areas of research paint a consistent picture: the pickup coordination problem is real, significant in scale, under-served by the market, navigable from a regulatory standpoint, and well-timed for investment.

Research Area	What We Found
Demand	6 distinct user segments affected. Office commuters and airport travelers face the highest frequency and severity. Women riders face the highest stakes. The problem is a near-daily experience for millions of users in India's top 6 cities.
Market Size	~1.4 billion Uber trips per year in India. Estimated 98 million trips annually affected by pickup confusion. Even conservative improvement scenarios represent tens of millions of dollars in recovered GMV.
Alternatives	Users rely on phone calls, WhatsApp, landmarks, and walking to workarounds. No competitor has solved this end-to-end. The 'last 100 metres' of pickup is a gap nobody owns.
Regulation	MVAG 2025 mandates real-time vehicle tracking and fare-from-pickup clarity. State rules are enabling bidirectional location sharing. DPDP Act requires consent-based location features. Constraints are manageable with thoughtful design.
Market Trends	Hyperlocal mapping maturity, 26.5% YoY Uber growth, rising competitive pressure, regulatory tailwinds, and growing user expectations for proactive apps all point to this being the right time to invest.

Key takeaway: *The research confirms this is a problem worth solving. The next step is to get in front of the most affected users — office commuters and airport travelers — to validate these hypotheses and understand the problem at the granular level before any solution is designed.*

2. Conduct In-depth User Interviews

2.1 Survey using SurveyMonkey

Survey Conducted with 25 users using SurveyMonkey platform that summarizes findings from a 25-person survey, groups respondents into meaningful segments, identifies the priority target, and builds a detailed user persona to guide product decisions.

Part A: Survey Insights

25 users responded to the survey titled 'Ride Hailing Pickup Experience in India.' Below are the key findings from each question, written in plain language, with the PM implication called out for each.

Q1 — Which apps do you use?

Finding: Uber is used by nearly all respondents. Ola is the second most common. Rapido has moderate presence. Namma Yatri, Meru, and Lyft are used by very few.

Implication: The feedback is primarily about Uber's experience. Any solution built here will directly address the pain points these users face on their most-used platform.

Q2 — How often do you ride?

Finding: The majority ride daily or several times a week. A smaller group rides once a week. Very few ride monthly or less.

Implication: This is a high-frequency user base. The pickup coordination problem is not occasional — it is a recurring, daily frustration. Solving it delivers compounding value with every single trip.

Q3 — How clear are pickup instructions?

Finding: Most respondents rated instructions as 'somewhat unclear' or 'neutral.' Very few found them 'very clear.' Almost nobody is confident they know exactly where to stand after booking.

Implication: The current in-app guidance is failing users. This validates that the problem is not just about GPS accuracy — it is also about how the app communicates pickup information to the rider.

Q4 — How often do drivers fail to find you?

Finding: 'Often' and 'sometimes' dominate the responses. A significant portion said 'always.' Almost nobody said 'never.'

Implication: Driver-rider location mismatch is near-universal in this group. This is not an edge case or a rare technical glitch — it is the default experience for most users.

Q5 — Satisfaction with pickup in crowded locations?

Finding: 'Dissatisfied' and 'very dissatisfied' are the most common responses. Very few are satisfied. Nobody is very satisfied.

Implication: The experience in complex environments — the exact environments Uber is most used in — is clearly broken. There is no silent majority who are okay with it. Dissatisfaction is widespread.

Q6 — What Specific Issues Have You Faced?

This was a multi-select question. The issues ranked from most to least cited:

Rank	Issue	PM Significance
#1	*Multiple calls to coordinate the pickup*	Calling the driver is the de facto product — not the app
#2	*Driver unable to locate the rider*	Core navigation failure between booking and arrival
#3	*Delays in pickup*	Direct impact on user time and loyalty
#4	*Confusion about pickup point*	App instructions are not clear enough post-booking
#5	*GPS location inaccurate*	Underlying data quality issue to address
#6	*Multiple entry/exit gates*	Environment complexity that the app does not account for
#7	*Driver stops at a different location*	Driver-side navigation failure
#8	*Cancellations*	Revenue and retention impact — end result of all the above

Q7 — What is your occupation?

Finding: Technology sector workers make up the largest group by a wide margin — nearly half the respondents. Finance and students are next. All other sectors are small.

Implication: The survey audience is predominantly urban tech workers. This shapes which segment to prioritise and ensures the persona is grounded in a real, dominant profile.

Q8 — Where do issues occur most often?

Finding: Office complexes and IT parks are the top two locations — clearly ahead of all others. Airports and railway stations come next. Metro stations, malls, and hospitals follow. Residential areas are the least problematic.

Implication: The problem is concentrated in structured, complex environments with multiple entry/exit points. These locations are not random — they are exactly where tech workers commute to and from every day.

Q9 — Open-Ended:

What information would make it easier for you to find your driver? and What information would help drivers find you more easily?

These are the verbatim responses grouped into themes. This is the richest qualitative data in the survey.

Theme	No. of Mentions	Sample Verbatim Responses
Accurate GPS / Precise Location	8–10 respondents	"Exact pin location" | "Use precise location" | "Accurate GPS" | "Pinpoint updated based on user location after booking"
Direct communication with driver	5–6 respondents	"Call immediately" | "Call driver" | "Need to respond to our calls"
Live location sharing	4–5 respondents	"I will send my live location to his WhatsApp number" | "Sending location"
Landmark-based guidance	2 respondents	"Landmark"
Driver knowledge & language	1 respondent	"Drivers knowledge regarding the locations and also the language barriers"
Vehicle / identity matching	1 respondent	"Vehicle number matching registered vehicle number in the app" | "Dress code and riders code on vehicle"
Network connectivity fix	1 respondent	"Solving network related issues"
No strong opinion / manageable	4 respondents	"NA" | "Nothing in particular. It is manageable." | "None"

Key Qualitative Insight: *Users are not asking for revolutionary technology. They want the basics to work — accurate location, reliable driver communication, and confidence that the driver knows exactly where to come. These are solvable problems with existing technology.*

Q10 — How do you currently solve pickup issues?

Finding: Calling the driver is by far the most common solution used by more than half. WhatsApp live location sharing is second. Walking to the main gate is third. Sharing landmarks and sending screenshots are used by fewer people.

Implication: The phone call has become the unofficial product feature that fills the gap Uber has left open. Every workaround here is an opportunity for the app to reclaim — and every workaround is a signal of what the feature should do.

Part B: User Segmentation

Based on the survey data, three distinct user segments emerge. Each segment has a different relationship with the pickup coordination problem — different frequency, different stakes, and different coping behaviour.

Dimension	Segment 1: The Frustrated Daily Commuter	Segment 2: The High-Stakes Occasional Traveler	Segment 3: The Adaptive Workaround User
Occupation	Technology, Finance, Corporate	Any sector — focused on trips, not occupation	Students, mixed sectors
Ride Frequency	Daily or several times a week	Several times a month	Once a week or less
Primary Locations	IT parks, office complexes	Airports, railway stations	Malls, metro stations, markets
Pain Level	Very High — daily recurring	High — low frequency but high consequence	Moderate — frustrated but tolerant
Typical Workaround	Calls driver immediately, walks to main gate	WhatsApp location, pre-books cab for important trips	Shares landmark, sends screenshot, walks to visible spot
Attitude	Knows workarounds but exhausted by repeating them daily	Will switch apps or pre-book if Uber fails them once too often	Has accepted friction as normal
Tech Comfort	High	Medium-High	Medium
Volume Potential	Highest — millions of daily trips	Medium — fewer trips but high GMV per trip	Lower — infrequent and spread across many locations

Part C: Target Segment

Based on the segmentation analysis, one segment stands out clearly as the right place to focus first.

TARGET SEGMENT

Segment 1: The Frustrated Daily Commuter

Urban tech and corporate workers commuting daily from IT parks and office complexes

Why This Segment?

Selection Criterion	Why This Segment Wins
Frequency of pain	They experience the problem every single day — not once a month. Solving this delivers value on every trip, not just occasionally.
Size in our survey	Technology workers dominate Q7. Office complexes and IT parks top Q8. The survey audience closely mirrors this segment.
Location match	IT parks and office complexes are the highest-complexity pickup

	environments — exactly where the problem is hardest and most persistent.
Volume impact	Millions of daily commute trips in India's top 6 cities. Even a small improvement in pickup success rate creates an enormous number of better experiences.
Tech adoption readiness	These are tech-savvy users who will quickly engage with a new in-app feature if it genuinely saves them time. Low adoption barrier.
Retention risk	Their daily frustration is cumulative. One too many bad mornings and they switch to Ola, Namma Yatri, or autos. They are loyal today but not unconditionally.
Commercial value	Daily riders are Uber's highest-GMV customers. Reducing cancellations and improving retention in this group directly improves revenue.

Why not the other segments first? Segment 2 (Airport Travelers) has high stakes per trip but lower frequency — they are a great second priority. Segment 3 (Adaptive Workaround Users) has already accepted the friction and is lower urgency. Start where the pain is daily and the volume is highest.

Part D: User Persona

A persona is a realistic, specific representation of the target segment — built from survey data, not imagination. It helps the product team make decisions grounded in a real type of user.

USER PERSONA

Arjun *(Name assumed)*

The Frustrated Daily Commuter

Age	28 years
Occupation	Software Engineer at a mid-size product company
City	Hyderabad — works in Hitech City / Madhapur corridor
Rides per week	8–10 (daily office commute + evening plans)
Primary pickup location	IT campus with 6+ towers, one main gate, security checkpoint
Apps used	Uber (primary), Ola (backup), Namma Yatri (installed, tries occasionally)
Tech comfort level	High — uses Google Maps, Slack, Notion, GitHub daily

A Day in Arjun's Life

Arjun books an Uber every morning at 8:50 AM from his office campus. He drops the pin at his building — Tower 3 — but the driver consistently ends up at the main campus gate, 400 metres away on the other side of a security checkpoint. He calls the driver and describes his location: 'Tower 3, near the canteen entrance, take the left from the main gate.' The driver confirms, then

takes another 4 minutes to navigate internally. Arjun walks halfway toward the gate anyway to save time.

He is almost always 5–8 minutes late to his morning standup. By Friday he has replayed this same call, with a different driver, four times. He is increasingly wondering whether just booking an auto from the road outside campus is actually faster.

Goals

- Get picked up at or very close to where he actually is — his building, not the main gate
- Spend zero mental energy coordinating with the driver after booking
- Know with confidence that the driver is coming to the right spot before they even start moving
- Not be late to work because of a coordination failure that repeats every day

Frustrations

1. He drops the exact same pin every morning and still gets a confused driver every time. The app does not remember or learn from his routine.

2. He has to call the driver on every trip. Calling should be the exception, not the default. The app is supposed to handle this.

3. Occasionally the driver cancels after waiting at the wrong gate — wasting 10 minutes and forcing a rebook during peak demand.

4. GPS pins him at the road in front of campus, not his actual tower. The app defaults to the building outline, not where he actually stands.

Current Workarounds

- Calls the driver immediately after booking — before the driver even starts moving
- Has saved a copy-paste message on his phone with his exact location description to share quickly
- Walks to the main gate when he is running late and cannot afford the coordination delay
- On some days, just books an auto from the main road to avoid the campus pickup entirely

What Arjun Wants from Uber

1. The app to remember that he always books from Tower 3 and pre-suggest that specific spot — not just the campus pin.

2. A way to send the driver a precise, real-time updated location pin that accounts for his exact standing spot inside the campus.

3. Confirmation that the driver has seen and acknowledged the pickup location before setting off — so he knows it is sorted.

4. If there is a better pickup point nearby that drivers can reach more easily, tell him proactively — before he is standing in the wrong spot.

Loyalty & Switching Risk

Factor	Arjun's Position
Current loyalty to Uber	Medium-High. Uber is his default but not his exclusive choice.
Switching trigger	3–4 bad mornings in a row, or one cancellation when he is already running late.
Alternatives he considers	Ola (already installed), Namma Yatri (trying occasionally), auto from the main road.
What would make him stay	A pickup experience that works without a phone call, even once. If it works, he will stick with Uber and recommend it.

key takeaway: *Arjun does not need a revolutionary feature. He needs Uber to do what it already promises — get a driver to where he actually is, without a phone call, without confusion, every single morning. The bar is not high. The gap between where the product is and where Arjun needs it to be is smaller than it appears. That makes this winnable.*

2.2 Prototype Building and Conducting In-depth Interviews Using Lovable: Uber "Find My Ride"

5 Users | In-Person & Remote Sessions

A prototype is build using Lovable where both the users – rider and driver get notified with the locations of theirs. The problem of confusion and levels of stress in finding or locating each other is addressed. While booking the ride by the rider, some alternatives kind of recommendations have been displayed and the rider can choose the option that best suits which help to locate the driver easily without any confusion. At the same time, driver can also meet the rider without any delay.

Three Features include:

- Intelligent pickup point recommendations are provided to riders based on accessibility, crowd density, and driver convenience.
- Precise micro-location pickup points are identified to improve rider-driver matching and reduce search time in complex or crowded areas.
- Real-time notifications are sent to drivers immediately when a rider confirms a pickup point, enabling faster navigation and smoother ride initiation.

The five users interviewed represent a range of ride-hailing habits. Two users ride frequently — three to four times a week — while the others use apps more occasionally, a few times a month or even less. This mix was useful because it gave us perspectives from both people who deal

with pickup problems regularly and those for whom a bad experience carries more weight since they ride so rarely.

The Problem before the Prototype

Before showing the prototype, we asked each person to recall a recent pickup that went wrong. The stories were strikingly consistent. Four out of five users described being in a busy location — a mall or a residential area — where the driver's GPS led them to a completely different entrance or side of the building. The typical response was to call the driver, give landmarks, and physically move to a more visible spot. One user reported calling the driver multiple times before the situation resolved, causing a ten-minute delay. Another said the driver arrived in a vehicle with a different registration number, adding to the confusion. The most frustrated user among the group simply gave up on the app entirely and chose another mode of transport. These warm-up responses confirmed that pickup confusion is not occasional — it is a predictable, recurring problem that erodes trust in the platform.

First Reactions to the Prototype

When the prototype was shown, the initial reactions were calm and positive rather than excited. Users described it as feeling familiar — "looks like ride booking on Uber," "similar to booking a ride on an app," "clear flow." No one was confused about what the screen was asking them to do, and all five said they immediately understood the pickup point selection. This is a good sign. It means the feature does not require any learning curve and fits naturally into the existing mental model users already have of how Uber works.

What Stood Out Most: Driver Notification Confirmation

The most meaningful moment for users was seeing the message "Your driver has been notified of your pickup point." Four of the five users responded to this screen with genuine enthusiasm. They described it as addressing exactly the gap they had experienced — the uncertainty of not knowing whether the driver has the right location before they even start moving. One user noted that this feature would benefit both the rider and the driver equally, and another, who had experienced multiple cancellations, said it gave them hope that the ride would not get cancelled. The driver-side guidance was also rated positively across the board. Users felt the instructions the driver received were clear and actionable, with one user specifically noting it was "simple to accept."

What Users Wish the Current App Already Did

When asked what single thing this prototype does that they wish Uber already had, the answers pointed to a few core needs. Accurate pickup pin placement came up consistently. ETA information combined with clear directional guidance — "where to go" — was highlighted by one user. Another mentioned arrival notifications as something they valued. A fourth user simply said "tracking," pointing to the anxiety that comes from not knowing where the driver actually is in relation to them. These responses suggest that the feature resonates most when it reduces uncertainty on both sides of the pickup simultaneously.

What the Prototype Did Not Address

One finding that came through unanimously from four of the five users was the language barrier. When a rider needs to guide a driver verbally, differences in language become a real obstacle. The prototype, despite its improvements in visual guidance, does not yet address this. It is the clearest gap identified in these sessions and likely deserves attention in the next iteration — whether through pre-set voice messages, regional language support, or a landmark-based fallback that does not require verbal communication.

Stress Ratings and What Would Help

Three users gave concrete stress ratings for their current pickup experience. Ratings of 4, 5, and 6 out of 10 suggest moderate but real anxiety — not panic, but enough friction to be noticeable on every trip. A fourth user rated it at 9, reflecting genuine distress, particularly around complex locations. What they said would bring that number down was consistent: accurate location display, better options for where to meet the driver, and features that remove the need to call. The prototype addressed most of these directly, which is why user confidence in it was high.

Summarizing it, across all five sessions, the prototype landed well. Users understood it immediately, trusted the driver notification feature, and saw it as a meaningful improvement over their current experience. The language barrier is the one unresolved issue worth prioritizing next. The stress ratings and the candid problem descriptions from the warm-up confirm that this is a real problem with a real audience — and that even small improvements in pickup clarity would make a significant difference to how people feel about using the app.

3. Summary of the Insights, Segment Defined, Target and Persona Defined

What the survey told (25 responses):

- Driver failing to find the rider is near-universal — "often" or "always" for most respondents
- Multiple calls to coordinate is the single biggest issue cited
- Nobody is satisfied with pickups in crowded locations — dissatisfied or very dissatisfied dominates
- Office complexes and IT parks are where the problem hurts most
- The #1 workaround is calling the driver. The #2 is sharing location on WhatsApp — both happening completely outside the Uber app
- Users do not want fancy technology. They want accurate location and a driver who knows exactly where to come, without a phone call

Three segments identified:

- Segment 1 — The Frustrated Daily Commuter: Tech/corporate workers, daily riders, IT parks and office campuses, highest frequency of pain
- Segment 2 — The High-Stakes Occasional Traveler: Any sector, airport and railway station users, lower frequency but higher consequences
- Segment 3 — The Adaptive Workaround User: Students and mixed sectors, weekly riders, malls and metro stations, have accepted the friction

Target segment chosen: Segment 1 — The Frustrated Daily Commuter. Highest volume, daily pain, tech-savvy enough to adopt a new feature, highest retention risk for Uber.

Persona — Arjun:

- 28-year-old Software Engineer, Hyderabad, Hitech City corridor
- Books Uber daily from a multi-tower IT campus
- Calls the driver every single morning because the pin lands at the main gate, not his tower
- Wants the app to remember his exact spot, confirm the driver has seen it, and guide both sides without a phone call
- Loyal to Uber today but one too many bad mornings away from switching

User Experience Summary with Prototype:

Across five users with varying ride-hailing habits, pickup confusion emerged as a consistent and recurring pain point — most commonly experienced at malls, office complexes, and residential areas where GPS mismatched the actual entrance or side of the building. The typical workaround was calling the driver multiple times, sharing landmarks, and physically walking to a more visible spot, with one user giving up entirely and switching to another mode of transport.

When shown the prototype, all five users understood the pickup point selection immediately without any explanation, describing it as feeling natural within the existing Uber flow. The standout moment was the "Your driver has been notified of your pickup point" confirmation — four users responded to this positively, citing it as the exact reassurance missing from the current experience. Driver-side guidance was also rated clearly and positively across the board.

When asked what they wished the current app already had, users pointed to accurate pin placement, arrival notifications, and real-time directional guidance — all of which the prototype directly addressed.

The one gap raised unanimously by four out of five users was the language barrier and other things like - what if the driver is not aware of the road works happening, to reach the rider taking long U-turns that possibly results delays and leading to cancellations again, which the prototype does not yet solve and stands out as the most important thing to address next. Suggesting the best to the driver can possibly mitigate the problem. Stress ratings for the current pickup experience ranged from 4 to 9 out of 10, and users consistently said that accurate location display and removing the need to call the driver would bring that number down significantly.